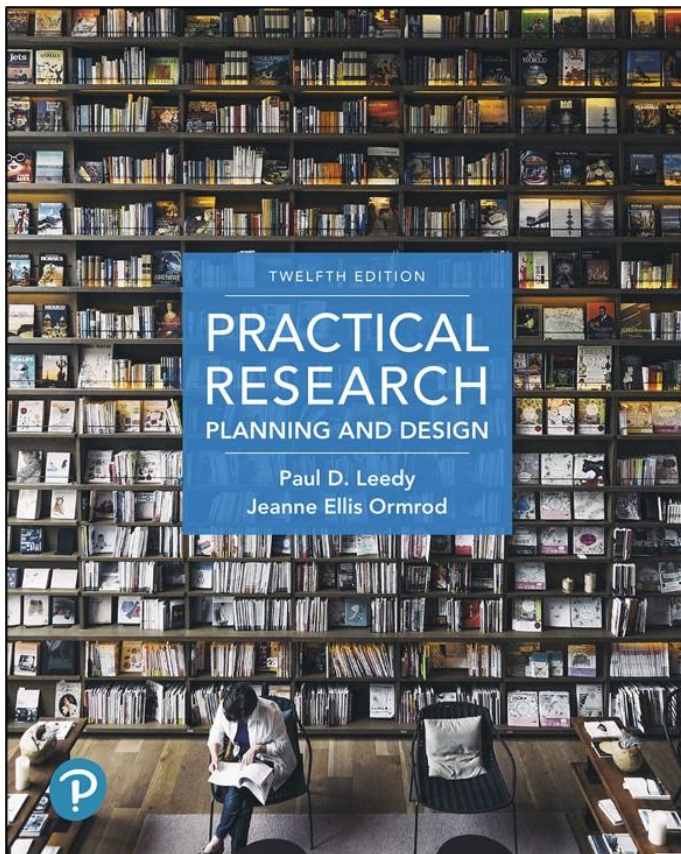


Practical Research: Planning and Design

Twelfth Edition



Chapter 12

Analyzing Qualitative and Mixed Methods Data

The Nature of Qualitative Analysis

- Combined with data collection
 - May lead to additional data collection
- Largely inductive
 - Flexible and open-ended

Strategies for Organization and Analysis (1 of 3)

1. Convert the data into one or more forms that will be easy to organize and analyze
2. Organize the data in a preliminary, superficial way that will enable you to locate them easily as you proceed.
3. Identify preliminary categories that are likely to be helpful in coding the data.

Strategies for Organization and Analysis (2 of 3)

4. Divide the data into meaningful units that will be individually coded.
5. Apply the initial coding scheme to a subset of the data.
6. Construct a final list of codes and subcodes, and define each code and subcode as specifically and concretely as possible.
7. Consider using two or more raters to code the data independently.

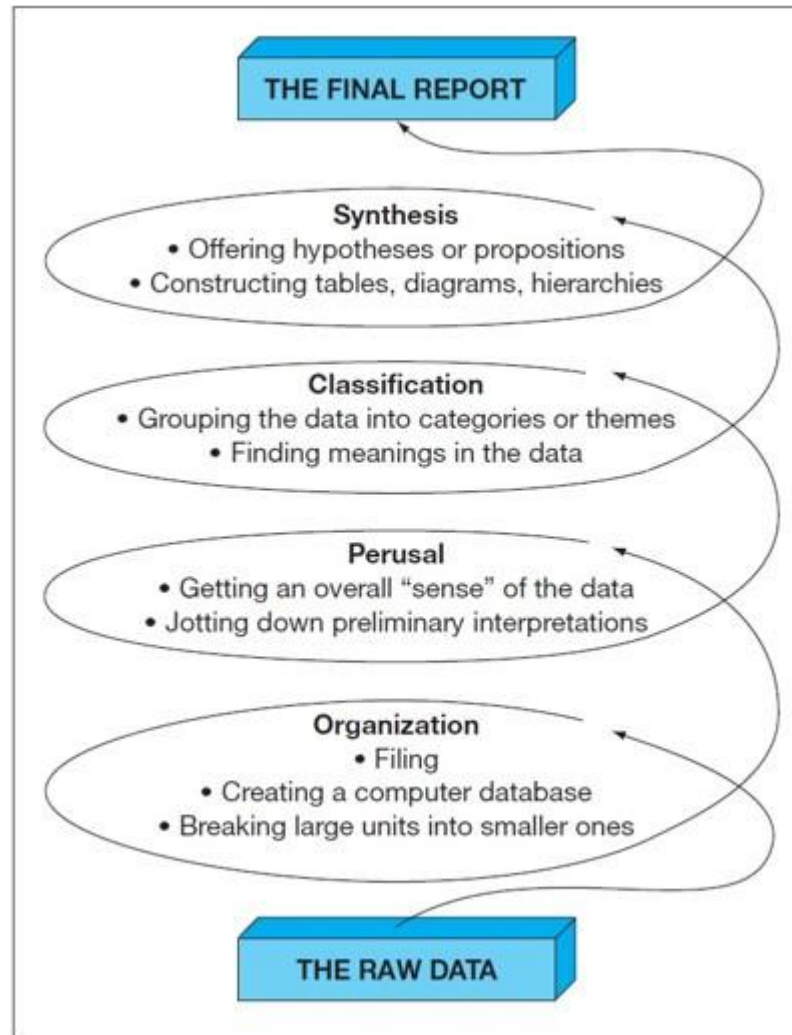
Strategies for Organization and Analysis (3 of 3)

8. Identify noteworthy patterns and relationships among the codes.
9. Be alert for exceptions, tensions, and contradictions within the data set.
10. Interpret the data in light of your research problem and questions.

Analysis as a Spiral (1 of 2)

- Creswell (2013) has described a **data analysis spiral** that helps give perspective to qualitative data analysis. In this approach, you go through the data several times using these steps:
 1. Organize the data
 2. Peruse the entire data set several times to get a sense of what it contains as a whole
 3. Identify general categories or themes
 4. Integrate and summarize the data for readers

Analysis as a Spiral (2 of 2)



Researcher-As-Instrument

- Qualitative research requires the researcher to make many judgment calls. Because of this, the research is essentially an instrument within the study. These strategies help to maintain credibility and trustworthiness:
 1. Strive for balance, fairness, and completeness
 2. Carefully document your analysis procedures
 3. In your final report, be up front about your personal biases

Analyzing and Interpreting Mixed-Methods Data (1 of 3)

- Strategies for analyzing and interpreting data in a mixed-methods study vary depending on the general design of the study.
- The mixed methodologist must decide early on whether they will:
 - give qualitative data and quantitative data equal weight in drawing conclusions
 - give higher importance to one form of data over the other

Analyzing and Interpreting Mixed-Methods Data (2 of 3)

- Data analysis in a mixed-methods study will probably include at least three of the following four steps:
 1. Condensing the data
 2. Depicting general patterns in the data in ways that enable quick visual inspection
 3. Transforming qualitative data into quantitative entities (an optional step)
 4. Systematically comparing and integrating results from the two types of data

Analyzing and Interpreting Mixed-Methods Data (3 of 3)

- Some strategies for comparing and integrating results may include:
 - Creating a two-column table
 - Identifying concrete examples within the qualitative data that give meaning and depth to the numbers
 - Count the number of times themes appear in interviews and then compare with frequency counts from survey responses
 - Divide participants into two or more groups based on demographics and statistically compare frequencies of codes or themes within qualitative data for each group

Systematic Reviews of Qualitative and Mixed-Methods Studies (1 of 2)

- Consolidating the results of many quantitative studies is done through meta-analysis. The qualitative and mixed-methods alternative is the systematic review.
- In a systematic review, research reports, rather than individual people or other individual entities, are the objects of the study.
- The researcher identifies and implements an explicit, rigorous method for selecting and analyzing research reports.

Systematic Reviews of Qualitative and Mixed-Methods Studies (2 of 2)

- Researchers conducting a systematic review are likely to:
 - Conduct an extensive search for studies related to the research problem
 - Evaluate the quality of each report and then choose to exclude or give less credence to certain reports
 - Code the contents of the reports for key ideas, concepts, themes, and/or theories
 - Perform one or more meta-analyses of any statistical findings reported in the studies

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